全民英檢中級 GEPT Intermediate | 第 36 單元 | 娛樂與媒體 · Entertainment & Media

The Night the Clown Went Live

小丑現場直播之夜

"Are you sure this is a good idea?" my cousin Mei-ling asked, pulling her red nose into place. It was the opening night of Dream Circus in Kaohsiung, and a television producer had just told her that the show would be televised live.

Mei-ling had been a clown for only six months. Before that, she had worked as a newscaster at a small radio station, reading bulletins about traffic and weather. "I wanted to entertain people, not inform them," she told me when she quit. Her parents thought she had gone crazy, but I had seen her make a whole bus laugh, so I believed in her.

"The preview went well yesterday," I said. "The comedian who performed before you said you were the best entertainer he had seen all year." "He was being kind," she whispered. "Tonight there are cameras." At that moment the producer waved. "Thirty seconds! And remember, do not look at the lens." Mei-ling took a deep breath and ran into the ring.

What happened next became a headline the following morning. Halfway through her act, a firework meant for the finale went off early, and the ring filled with pink smoke. Instead of freezing, Mei-ling pretended to look for the firework, crawling under the elephant stand and sneezing loudly. The audience exploded with applause. The newspaper published a photo of her covered in pink powder, and the story was shared thousands of times online. The circus had never had such publicity. "So," I asked her afterward, "was it a good idea?" She grinned under the paint. "The best idea I have ever had. Next time, though, I want to know where the fireworks are."

重點單字 Key Vocabulary

單字	詞性	中文	例句
entertain	*v.*	娛樂；使歡樂	The magician entertained the children for an hour. 魔術師逗孩子們開心了一個小時。
clown	*n.*	小丑	The clown at the party made balloon animals. 派對上的小丑做了氣球動物。

producer	*n.*	製作人	The producer decided to film the show in Tainan. 製作人決定在台南拍攝這個節目。
televise	*v.*	電視轉播	The baseball final will be televised nationwide. 棒球決賽將在全國電視轉播。
bulletin	*n.*	簡報；公告	The weather bulletin warned of heavy rain tonight. 天氣簡報警告今晚有大雨。
preview	*n.*	預演；預告	We watched a preview of the new movie online. 我們在網路上看了新電影的預告。
comedian	*n.*	喜劇演員	The comedian's jokes made the whole room laugh. 那位喜劇演員的笑話讓全場大笑。
headline	*n.*	頭條新聞；標題	The earthquake was the headline in every newspaper. 那場地震是每家報紙的頭條。
applause	*n.*	掌聲	The singer bowed as the applause grew louder. 掌聲越來越大時，歌手鞠了躬。
publicity	*n.*	宣傳；知名度	The new restaurant got a lot of publicity from the news report. 那家新餐廳因新聞報導得到很多宣傳。

片語 Phrases

take a deep breath	深吸一口氣	Take a deep breath before you walk on stage. 上台前先深吸一口氣。
go off	（煙火、炸彈等）爆開；（鬧鐘）響	The fireworks went off at exactly midnight. 煙火在午夜整點施放。
believe in	相信（某人的能力）	My coach always believed in me. 我的教練一直相信我。

文法與句型 Grammar

S＋V ..., V-ing ...（分詞構句表示同時進行的動作）

用現在分詞片語補充說明主詞同時在做的另一個動作，兩個動作的主詞相同。文中 Mei-ling asked, pulling her red nose into place 表示她一邊問一邊戴正鼻子。

She walked into the room, carrying a big box.

她抱著一個大箱子走進房間。

What＋V ...＋V（what 引導的名詞子句當主詞）

what 子句可以當整句的主詞，意思是「……的事情」。文中 What happened next became a headline 的主詞是 What happened next（接下來發生的事）。

What she said surprised everyone.

她說的話讓大家都很驚訝。

讀完文章後，請到「皇家大衛英文閱讀集點站」完成本單元測驗，答對即可累積點數。